

# ISAAC D. MEHLHAFF

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Chicago, IL 60637

Updated: May 20, 2026  
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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

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### The University of Chicago

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| Neubauer Family Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science | 2025 -      |
| Faculty Member, Committee on Data Science                            | 2025 -      |
| Faculty Affiliate, Chicago Center for Computational Social Science   | 2025 -      |
| Faculty Affiliate, Data Science Institute                            | 2025 -      |
| Faculty Affiliate, Program in Political Economy                      | 2025 -      |
| Postdoctoral Scholar, Data Science Institute                         | 2023 - 2024 |

### Texas A&M University

|                                                      |             |
|------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science | 2024 - 2025 |
| Research Affiliate, Institute of Data Science        | 2024 - 2025 |

### Institut d'études politiques de Paris

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| Visiting Scholar, AxPo Observatory of Market Society Polarization | 2025 |
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## EDUCATION

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### The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

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|-------------------------------------------|------|
| Doctor of Philosophy in Political Science | 2023 |
| Master of Arts in Political Science       | 2020 |

### University of Wisconsin-Madison

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|--------------------------------------------------|------|
| Bachelor of Arts with Honors in the Liberal Arts | 2018 |
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## BOOK

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**Isaac D. Mehlhaff.** *Mass Polarization across Time and Space*. New York: Cambridge University Press, Elements in Comparative Political Behavior. 2025.

## PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

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Marc J. Hetherington, Andrew M. Engelhardt, and **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. "More Than a Partisan Pandemic: Worldview and COVID-19 Response in the United States." *Advances in Political Psychology* (forthcoming).

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. "A Group-Based Approach to Measuring Polarization." *American Political Science Review* 118, no. 3 (August 2024): 1518-1526.

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, Matías C. Tarillo, Ayelén Vanegas, and Marc J. Hetherington. "Partisanship and the Pandemic: How and Why Americans Followed Party Cues on COVID-19." *Journal of Health Politics, Policy, and Law* 49, no. 3 (June 2024): 351-374.

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, Timothy J. Ryan, Marc J. Hetherington, and Michael B. MacKuen. "Where Motivated Reasoning Withers and Looms Large: Fear and Partisan Reactions to the COVID-19 Pandemic." *American Journal of Political Science* 68, no. 1 (January 2024): 5-23.

Sam Schmitt, **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, and Emily Cottle Ommundsen. "Integrating Classroom and Community with Undergraduate Civically Engaged Research." *PS: Political Science and Politics* 56, no. 4 (October 2023): 469-474.

## PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

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Amirhossein Farzam, Shashank Shekhar, **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, and Marco Morucci. “Multi-Task Learning Improves Performance in Deep Argument Mining Models.” *Proceedings of the 11th Workshop on Argument Mining*, Association for Computational Linguistics (August 2024): 46-58.

## UNDER REVIEW

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Robert C. Luskin, Daron R. Shaw, Marc J. Hetherington, and **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Do Political Factors Help Explain Partisan Bias in Polling? An Examination of Signed Forecast Errors in Pre-Election Media Surveys.”

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Mass Polarization and Democratic Decline: Evidence from a Half-Century of Public Opinion.”

İrem Betül Koçak, **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, and Başak Taraktaş. “When Talk is Not Enough: Social Context and the Persistence of Ideological Polarization.”

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. *The Persuasive Citizen: How Political Debate Can Change Minds and Heal Divides*.

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Political Argumentation and Attitude Change in Online Interactions.”

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “How Executive Institutions Shape Affective Polarization: Evidence from Israel, 1975-2001.”

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Leveraging Time-Series Information to Improve Small-Area Estimation.”

Kevin J. Angell and **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Talking Politics on the Job: How Corporate Advocacy Shapes Political Participation.”

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, Molly Offer-Westort, and Nick Feamster. “Interpersonal Discussion and Persuasion in Political Settings.”

Marc S. Jacob and **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Reconsidering the Polarization and Democracy Nexus: Concepts, Causation, and Conditioning Factors.”

Amirhossein Farzam, **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**, and Marco Morucci. “Multi-Task Learning in Social Scientific Applications.”

## SOFTWARE

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**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. PolarCAP: Access the Polarization in Comparative Attitudes Project (version 1.1.0). *Comprehensive R Archive Network*. <https://cran.r-project.org/package=PolarCAP>.

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. CPC: Implementation of Cluster-Polarization Coefficient (version 2.6.0). *Comprehensive R Archive Network*. <https://cran.r-project.org/package=CPC>.

## OTHER WRITING

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**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Does Political Polarization Really Undermine Democracy? Maybe Not.” *The University of Chicago Data Science Blog* (July 29, 2024).

Marc J. Hetherington and **Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “American attitudes toward covid-19 are divided by party. The pandemic itself might undo that.” *The Washington Post* (August 18, 2020).

**Isaac D. Mehlhaff**. “Subverting Solidarity: The Role of American Organized Labor in Pursuing United States Foreign Policy Objectives in Chile, 1961-1973.” *The Burkhardt Review* 1, no. 2 (2018): 24-40.

## FUNDING

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### **National Science Foundation**

Graduate Research Fellowship, \$138,000 2020 - 2023

### **Society for Political Methodology**

Travel Award, \$1,650 2023

### **Midwest Political Science Association**

Pi Sigma Alpha Travel Award, \$500 2023

### **American Political Science Association**

Centennial Center Research Grant, \$2,400 2022

Travel Award, \$150 2022

### **The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**

Graduate Fellowship, Program for Public Discourse, \$1,000 2021 - 2022

Americas Graduate Fellowship, Institute for the Study of the Americas, \$5,000 2018 - 2020

Uhlman Research Grant, Department of Political Science, \$2,000 2019

### **European Consortium for Political Research**

Travel Award, €150 2019

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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### **The University of Chicago**

Neubauer Family Assistant Professorship 2025

### **American Political Science Association**

Honorable Mention, Best Dissertation in Political Psychology 2024

### **The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill**

Dean's Distinguished Dissertation Award in the Social Sciences 2024

James W. Prothro Award for Best Master's Thesis in Political Science 2021

Associate Level of Accomplishment, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning 2021

### **University of Wisconsin-Madison**

William Jennings Bryan Award for Best Thesis in Political Science 2018

William F. Allen Research Award, Department of History 2017

Phi Beta Kappa, College of Letters and Science 2017

## INVITED TALKS AND WORKSHOPS

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University of Notre Dame, Kellogg Institute for International Studies 2026

The University of Chicago Francis and Rose Yuen Campus in Hong Kong,  
New Horizons for AI Research in the Social Sciences and Humanities

The University of Chicago, Computational Social Science Workshop 2025

Institut d'études politiques de Paris, Centre for Political Research

Yale University, Generative Artificial Intelligence and Sociology Workshop 2024

Texas A&M University, Department of Political Science

The University of Chicago, Quantitative Methods Workshop 2023

The University of Chicago, American Politics Workshop

University of California, Los Angeles, Politics and Computational Social Science Conference

The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, American Politics Research Group 2022

Rice University, Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science

European University Institute, Conference on Contemporary Divides in Western Societies 2021

European Consortium for Political Research, Standing Group on Latin American Politics 2019

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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|                                                                        |                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Annual Conference on Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior    | 2026              |
| Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association           | 2021 - 2026       |
| Annual Conference of the Midwest Political Science Association         | 2022 - 2026       |
| Keeping the Republic Conference, University of Notre Dame              | 2024              |
| Association for Computational Linguistics, Workshop on Argument Mining | 2024              |
| Annual Conference of the Society for Political Methodology             | 2020, 2022 - 2024 |
| Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association           | 2021              |

## TEACHING

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### The University of Chicago

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|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| SOSC 13300: Social Science Inquiry III                       | 2026        |
| PLSC 20150: The Art of Productive Political Debate           | 2026        |
| PLSC 30500: Introduction to Quantitative Social Science      | 2025        |
| PLSC 49999: Math Camp (Faculty Supervisor)                   | 2025        |
| Data Science Clinic, Data Science Institute (Project Mentor) | 2023 - 2024 |

### Texas A&M University

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| POLS 309: Polimetrics | 2024 |
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### The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

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| POLI 276: Everyday Political Theory: Seeing Like a Citizen (Graduate Consultant) | 2022 |
| Agora Fellows, Program for Public Discourse (Facilitator)                        | 2021 |
| POLI 203: Race, Innocence, and the End of the Death Penalty (Teaching Assistant) | 2020 |
| POLI 100: American Democracy in Changing Times (Teaching Assistant)              | 2019 |
| POLI 208: Political Parties and Elections (Instructional Assistant)              | 2018 |

## ADVISING

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|                                             |         |                                           |      |
|---------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------------------------|------|
| Cemal Yilmaz, PhD, Political Science        | Ongoing | Egemen Aray, MA, Social Sciences          | 2026 |
| Ella Storms, BA Honors, Political Science   |         | Sylvia Dou, MA, Social Sciences           |      |
| Ilana Gellman, BA Honors, Political Science |         | Ye Tian, MA, Computational Social Science |      |
|                                             |         | Xuan Qu, MA, Social Sciences              |      |

## SERVICE

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### The University of Chicago

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|-----------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Member, Quantitative Methods Search Committee | 2025 - 2026 |
| Member, Data Science Joint PhD Committee      | 2025 - 2026 |

### American Political Science Association

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| Mentor, Early Career Fellows Program, Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Section | 2025 - 2026 |
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### Texas A&M University

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| Member, Graduate Admissions Committee | 2024 - 2025 |
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### The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

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| Graduate Student President, Department of Political Science                   | 2022 - 2023 |
| Coordinator, Formal and Quantitative Seminar                                  | 2022 - 2023 |
| Committee Member, Charles Robson Award for Excellence in Graduate Instruction | 2022, 2023  |
| Member, Removing Inequities in Political Science Working Group                | 2020 - 2023 |
| Member, Graduate Stipends Committee                                           | 2020 - 2021 |
| Coordinator, UNC-Duke Working Group on Latin American Politics                | 2019 - 2020 |

### Discussant

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| Virtual Workshop Series, Polarization Consortium                                  | 2025        |
| Large Language Models Workshop, European Political Science Association            | 2025        |
| Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association                      | 2024 - 2025 |
| Annual Conference of the Midwest Political Science Association                    | 2025 - 2026 |
| Annual Conference of the Society for Political Methodology                        | 2024 - 2025 |
| American Politics Research Group, The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill | 2023        |

**Reviewer**

*American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, APSA Centennial Center, British Journal of Political Science, Electoral Studies, IEEE Transactions on Network Science and Engineering, The Journal of Politics, NSF GRFP Peer Review Workshop, Perspectives on Politics, Political Analysis, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Political Psychology, Political Science Research and Methods, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, PS: Political Science and Politics, Public Opinion Quarterly, The Social Science Journal, Spatial Demography, Time-Sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences*